You may notice

Sadness, worry, fear, anger, or feeling numb

Feeling very tired, aches and pains, headaches. If pain, fever or another body problem worries you, see a health worker.

Trouble falling asleep, or bad dreams

Upsetting memories that come back, or trouble concentrating

Feeling irritable, or wanting to be alone

Children react too

They may cling to you, cry more, or become very quiet. Stay close, explain simply what is happening, and keep familiar routines.

Sources: WHO, Psychological First Aid: Guide for Field Workers (2011); WHO, Doing What Matters in Times of Stress (2020); IASC, Guidelines on MHPSS in Emergency Settings (2007); WHO/UNHCR, mhGAP Humanitarian Intervention Guide (2015). This material draws on these publications; it was not created by WHO or IASC, which are not responsible for its content.

Take-home leaflet · A4 · Chapter 1 of 6 · English review draft · Not for field distribution. Fictional illustrations, AI-assisted and developed under human direction.

Ask for help early

Feelings getting worse, not going away, or making daily life hard? Talk to a health worker. You do not have to wait.

Get help now

In danger, or thinking of harming yourself? Get help now. Ask a health worker or responder, and ask someone you trust to stay with you.

Help near you: _____ (filled in and checked locally)

Support is for everyone, including people with disabilities and older people. Ask for large print, sign language or more time.

Look after yourself. Look after each other.

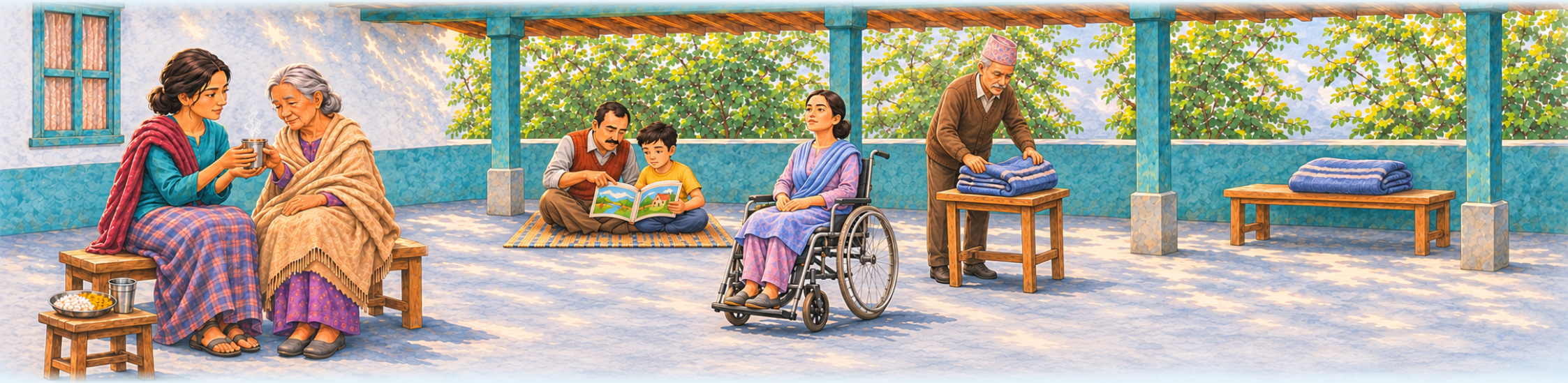
You are not alone

Many people feel this way after the flood.



A frightening experience can change how we feel, think, sleep and get along with others. These are common reactions. People react in different ways, and there is no right or wrong way to feel. Many reactions ease with time and support.

Small things that can help



Be with someone you trust

Talk, or simply sit together quietly. You do not have to tell your story.

Rest, eat and drink safe water

Rest when you can. Eat regular meals if you can, and drink safe water.

Keep safe: follow local warnings. Do not enter floodwater or damaged buildings.

Want to read more? WHO's illustrated guide Doing What Matters in Times of Stress is available in Nepali.

Breathe slowly

Breathe in slowly, then breathe out slowly. Notice three things you can see and hear around you. Stop if it makes you feel worse.

Do one small task

Choose one thing you can manage today. Take breaks; you do not have to do everything at once.

Keep daily routines

Regular times for meals, sleep and play help children and adults feel safer.

If you take medicine from a doctor, do not stop it without asking a health worker.

Ways of coping that can make things worse

Your feelings are not wrong. But some ways of coping can harm you or the people around you:

Drinking alcohol or using drugs to forget or to sleep

Staying away from everyone for a long time

Taking anger out on others, especially children

Working all day without any rest

If you notice these in yourself or someone close to you, talk to someone you trust or a health worker.